

Cyclistic Bike-Share Analysis

Executive Strategy & Conversion Insights Report

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Dataset Scope: July 2025 – June 2026 (5.76M Trips)

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1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Cyclistic’s long-term financial growth hinges on maximizing the number of annual memberships. While casual riders generate significant revenue through single-ride and full-day passes, annual members are substantially more profitable and provide steady, predictable recurring revenue.

Core Analytical Strategic Question

How do annual members and casual riders use Cyclistic bikes differently, and how can data-driven insights be leveraged to convert casual riders into committed annual members?

Through rigorous ETL cleaning and SQL exploratory analysis of **5,764,536 cleaned trip records** spanning July 2025 to June 2026, clear user behavioral profiles emerged. Casual riders represent over **2.03 million trips (35.25%)**. They are not merely one-off tourists; they exhibit consistent, high-volume seasonal, weekend, and late-afternoon leisure usage. Converting a fraction of this highly engaged group presents Cyclistic's highest-ROI marketing opportunity.

2. KEY DATA & PROFILE SUMMARY

5.76M

TOTAL CLEANED
TRIPS

64.75%

MEMBER TRIP
SHARE

35.25%

CASUAL TRIP
SHARE

19.29 min

CASUAL AVG
DURATION

User Metric / Dimension	Annual Members	Casual Riders	Key Behavioral Variance
Total Trips	3,732,745 (64.75%)	2,031,791 (35.25%)	Members form baseline; Casuals represent huge conversion TAM
Average Trip Duration	12.32 minutes	19.29 minutes	Casual rides are 56.6% longer (leisure/exploration)
Preferred Bike Type	65.60% Electric / 34.40% Classic	68.97% Electric / 31.03% Classic	Identical fleet preference; equipment is <i>not</i> a barrier
Peak Usage Days	Tuesday–Thursday (16.2% peak)	Saturday–Sunday (21.1% peak)	Members commute on weekdays; Casuals ride on weekends

User Metric / Dimension	Annual Members	Casual Riders	Key Behavioral Variance
Peak Usage Hours	8:00 AM & 5:00 PM Spikes	12:00 PM – 5:00 PM Curve	Bimodal daily work commute vs. steady afternoon leisure
Top Stations	Canal & Madison, State & Chicago	Navy Pier, DuSable Lake Shore Dr	Commercial Transit Hubs vs. Waterfront Tourist Docks

3. STRATEGIC ANALYTICAL INSIGHTS

Insight 1: Equipment Parity Eliminates Fleet Friction

Both user segments demonstrate near-identical preferences for bike hardware, with **~69% of casual riders** and **~66% of members** choosing electric bikes. This proves that casual riders do not avoid annual memberships because of equipment limitations. Product experience on the bike itself is identical; the friction lies entirely in pricing structure and membership framing.

Insight 2: Divergent Temporal Patterns (Utility vs. Recreation)

Member rides align tightly with Chicago’s professional working hours. Member volume exhibits steep spikes at **8:00 AM (7.3%)** and **5:00 PM (10.8%)** on weekdays. Conversely, casual usage surges on weekends (**Saturday reaching 21.1% of total casual volume**) and grows smoothly throughout the afternoon. Furthermore, casual demand experiences severe winter contraction (dropping under 2% in Jan/Feb), whereas annual members maintain essential commuting baseline trips year-round.

Insight 3: Geographic Clustering & Station Hotspots

Casual trips originate and terminate at waterfront leisure landmarks. **Navy Pier** alone generated **45,972 start trips** and **47,271 end trips** for casual users. In contrast, top member stations are clustered around commercial commuter arteries like *Canal St & Madison St* (22,534 trips) and major subway junctions.

4. ACTIONABLE MARKETING RECOMMENDATIONS (ACT PHASE)

1

Launch "Weekend & Summer Pass" Conversion Tiers
Strategy: Introduce a seasonal "Weekend-Warrior" or 4-Month Summer Membership pass. Since casual users peak heavily from June to September and on Saturdays/Sundays, a lower-tier membership tailored to seasonal leisure riders acts as an ideal gateway product that can automatically roll over into an discounted annual pass.

2 Geofenced & Station-Specific Digital Campaigns

Strategy: Focus digital advertising and physical kiosk promotional codes directly at top casual hotspots (Navy Pier, DuSable Lake Shore Dr, Millennium Park). Target users ending rides at these stations with real-time app notifications: *"You could have saved \$12 on this trip with an Annual Pass. Click here to credit today's ride toward a membership!"*

3 Gamified "Commuter Trial" Incentives During Peak Hours

Strategy: Over 9.5% of casual rides occur during 5:00 PM peak hours. Many casual riders are likely non-subscribing daily commuters. Launch a "5-Day Commuter Challenge" via the app offering bonus e-bike ride credits for completing 3 weekday rides during peak hours, demonstrating the financial savings of an annual membership.

4 E-Bike Credit Incentive Bundles

Strategy: Leverage the strong preference for e-bikes (68.97% casual preference) by offering 60 minutes of free monthly e-bike unlock/ride credits exclusively with annual membership subscriptions.